

Beauty & Brain: Improving Member Engagement



Company Access

Beauty and Brain (Rutgers NB Student Organization)

- Established: February 2025
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Background & Secondary Research

About the Organization:

- Student org focused on beauty, skincare, and careers
- ~25–30 active members (goal: 50)
- Diverse membership, primarily female

1,300 + Followers
~ 25-30 Active
Members

Market Position

- No direct competition
- Competes for student time and attention



High Awareness, Low Engagement

Data Collection Methods & Timeline

Research Approach:

- 4-week data collection process



- Interviews 
 - Executive board members
 - General members

- Observations and follow-ups



What We Measured:

- Attendance rates
- Participation levels

Key Finding:
Less than 40% attendance

Management issues / Output Problem

Low Member Engagement

Management Perspective

- Inconsistent event attendance
- Focus on recruiting rather than improving events
- Limited ability to plan impactful activities

Member Perspective

- Lack of motivation to attend
- Weak connection to the organization
- Competing priorities (school, other activities)

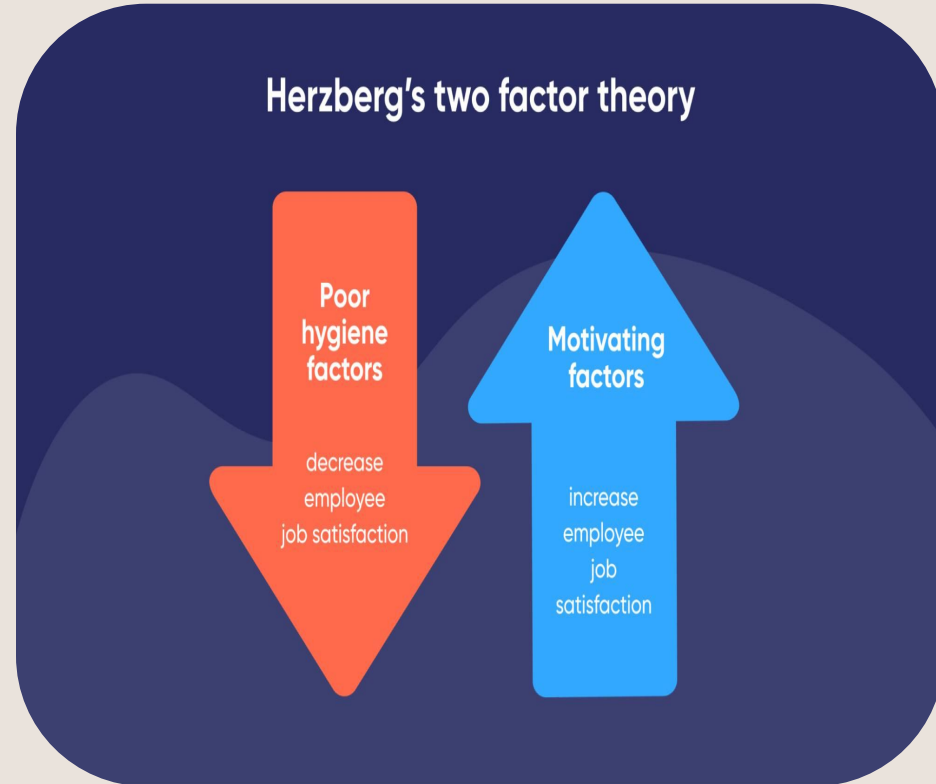
Topic 1: Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory

Motivators (Drive engagement)

- Recognition → members feel valued
- Responsibility → clear roles
- Growth → opportunities to develop

Hygiene Factors (Prevent dissatisfaction)

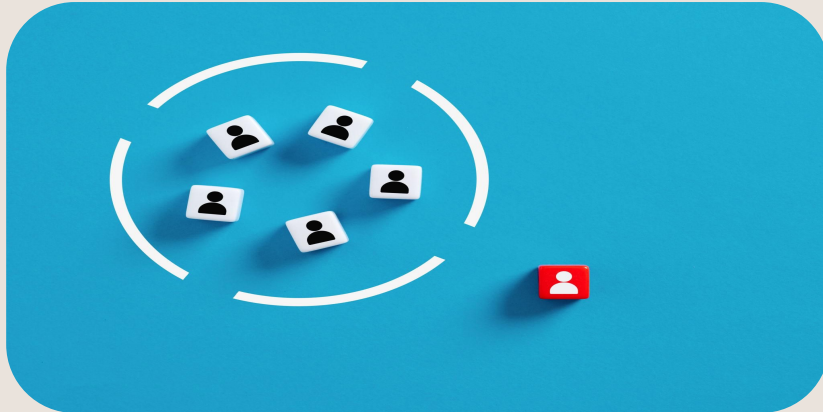
- Communication → clear & consistent
- Structure → organized system
- Expectations → defined roles



Applying Herzberg to Beauty & Brain

Motivator Gaps

- Little to no recognition
- Limited involvement
- No sense of impact



Hygiene Issues

- Unclear expectations
- Inconsistent communication
- Lack of structure



Key Insight

Root Issues

- Low motivation → no strong reason to attend
- Poor structure → confusion & frustration

Result: Low participation & engagement



Impact on Members

- Don't feel valued
- Don't feel responsible
- Don't feel connected

Topic 2: Tuckman's 5 Stages of Group Development (Norming Phase)

Tuckman's theory breaks down how teams grow and become effective over time into five stages: forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning

The Norming Phase

- Building group cohesiveness
- Setting norms
- Establishing roles
- Creating a “we feeling” among the group



Applying Tuckman to Beauty & Brain

Why the Norming phase?

- Relatively new organization
- Roles being formed
- Experiencing need for structure

Evidence

- Organization is about a year old
- No clear expectation of general members
- Most participation is from executive board



Key Insight

Root Issues

- Lack of norms
- Low accountability

Result: Unclear expectations and inconsistent participation



Impact on Members

- Don't understand responsibilities
- Don't feel connected
- Low desire/requirement to participate

Recommendation #1: Increasing Motivational Factors & Addressing Hygiene Factors

- Implement a member motivation and recognition system to increase engagement
- Introduce a monthly recognition program for active members
- Create professional development opportunities:
 - Leadership/involvement opportunities
 - Career-focused workshops & networking events
 - Skill-building events with clear member value
- Goal: Increase active participation by **25% within 4 months**
 - Measured through attendance and engagement tracking data
- Improve hygiene factors through stronger communication:
 - Shared event calendar updated weekly
 - Clear event expectations before meetings
 - Standardized post-event feedback surveys
- Goal: Improve member satisfaction by **20% within 4 months**
 - Measured through survey responses and reduced scheduling confusion



Best Practices & Potential Downsides of Recommendation #1

Best Practices

- Recognition programs in student/professional organizations (e.g., RAMS, LIBOR)
 - Monthly member recognition
 - Incentives for active participation
- Professional development opportunities
 - Leadership involvement opportunities
 - Career-focused workshops and networking events

Potential Downsides

- Recognition systems may overemphasize highly active members
 - Less active members may feel excluded
- Increased workload for executive board
 - More coordination for events and recognition tracking
- Risk of unintended consequences:
 - Incentives may create unequal participation
 - Members may participate for rewards rather than commitment



Recommendation #2: Establish Clear Norms & Expectations

- Implement a formalized norms system to clarify member expectations
- Introduce a norms contract signed by members upon joining
- Create a structured communication system:
 - Weekly reminders (GroupMe/Email)
 - Pre-meeting expectation announcements
 - Post-meeting follow-ups
- Goal: Increase member engagement by 20% within 4 months
 - Measured through event attendance and participation data
- Clear expectations + consistent communication → greater engagement and participation



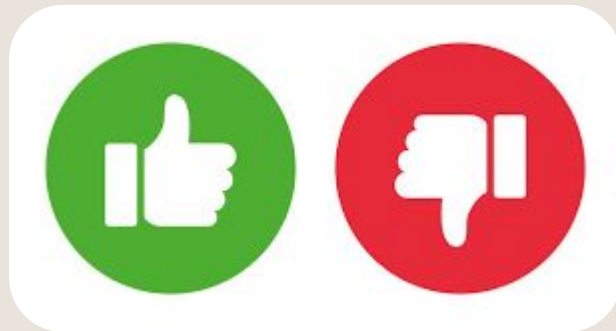
Best Practices & Potential Downsides of Recommendation #2

Best Practices:

- Structured onboarding systems (e.g., Alpha Kappa Psi)
 - Participation agreements
 - Clear expectations from the start
- Team charters in organizations
 - Define roles, expectations, communication norms
- Both practices increase accountability and consistency

Potential Downsides:

- May feel too rigid/strict for a student organization
- Increased workload for executive board
- Risk of unintended consequences:
 - Pressure on members
 - Reduced enjoyment
 - Possible drop in participation if expectations feel too strict



Communication Strategies & Influencing Tactics

For Recommendation 1:

- Social Proof (people emulate the actions of others):
- Can be used by showing success from similar organizations:
 - Rutgers Association of Marketing and Strategy (RAMS)
 - Little Investment Bankers of Rutgers (LIBOR)
- Highlight measurable outcomes (higher attendance, engagement)
- Reduces uncertainty and increases engagement

For Recommendation 2:

Consistency (people align with clear commitments):

- Have members actively, publicly, and voluntarily commit (sign norms contract)
- Increases likelihood they follow through with expectations

Authority (people defer/listen to experts):

- Support recommendation with research + proven examples
- Positions Beauty & Brain as credible and expert-backed
- Using these principles will increase trust, credibility, and willingness to implement the recommendations

THANK YOU!